Outlook

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Follow-up: test the mule hypothesis without labelling the customer

Hi all,

I may be joining dots that do not belong together, so please challenge the premise.

Financial Crime wants to test whether rapid receipt and onward movement forms a network pattern or reflects ordinary customer behaviour. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

Could the answer be that new accounts act as pass-through accounts? Or are we actually seeing that salary, family support or business cash flow explains the pattern? I also do not want us to miss the possibility that shared beneficiaries connect otherwise separate customers.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use December 2023 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The practical decision is which cases deserve investigation and which monitoring rule needs a better peer group. Please send a control view with the exceptions, owner and reason each item was included; I need the exceptions and counter-examples, not only an average.

Work from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; monthly customer and KYC snapshots; debit-order mandates, collection dates, suspensions and cancellations. The output is a triage hypothesis. Do not label a customer a mule without investigation and external evidence.

Regards